Regularised transformation-elastic cloaking of a circular cavity embedded in an elastic medium: validated ideal cloak and optimised pixelated Cauchy cloaks for bulk waves

David Aznaurov[a,b], David Piliposyan[a], Danila Rukhovich[a], Sébastien Guenneau[c]

[a] *M:3L Lab, Institute of Mechanics, 24B Baghramyan Ave., 0019 Yerevan, Armenia*
[b] *Biutopic, 18 Rue Paul Ramadier, 44201 Nantes, France*
[c] *The Blackett Laboratory, Department of Physics, UMI 2004 Abraham de Moivre-CNRS, Imperial College London, London SW7 2AZ, United Kingdom*

Abstract

We study the continuous transformation-elastic cloak for a traction-free circular cavity fully embedded in an isotropic elastic medium and excited by a localised harmonic force that radiates both pressure and shear waves. The singular radial map is replaced by a map from $\varepsilon \le R \le b$ onto $a \le r \le b$, and the full Brun–Guenneau–Movchan tensor is kept, without minor symmetry. We prove that the regularised cloak reproduces outside $r = b$ exactly the field of a traction-free hole of radius ε in the background, which provides an exact reference for separating regularisation error from implementation and discretisation error. The problem is solved with quadratic finite elements and a perfectly matched layer. The numerical model is verified against a closed-form Green tensor, a superposition identity and a mirror symmetry, all proved here. At $\varepsilon/a = 0.01$ and $b = \lambda_S$, the normalised exterior error in total displacement magnitude is 6.7×10^{-5}, against 0.158 for the uncloaked cavity. The error scales as ε^2. Across six combinations of source position and force direction and for $0.1 \le b/\lambda_S \le 2.5$, it stays between 2×10^{-6} and 3×10^{-4}, whereas the uncloaked cavity reaches 0.2. We then replace the ideal medium by 60 to 500 uniform pixels of admissible Cauchy material (minor- and major-symmetric, positive definite, positive density), parametrised by a neural field and optimised with an adjoint gradient through the finite-element model. Pixels alone cost little, whereas symmetrising the ideal tensor leaves

the cavity no better hidden than without a cloak. Optimisation recovers most of this loss: on source positions never used in training, a 500-pixel design reduces the median error from 0.158 to 0.042 at the training frequency, and a design trained on a band of frequencies reduces it by a factor of 1.4 to 2.3 across $0.5 \leq b/\lambda_S \leq 1.5$.

Keywords: elastic cloaking, transformation elasticity, bulk waves, near-cloak, perfectly matched layer, finite elements

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1. Introduction

Transformation methods design a material distribution from a coordinate map, so that waves pass around a region as if it were absent [1]. In elasticity, the Navier equations are not form invariant under a general map [2], and the choice of the relation between the displacements in the virtual and physical domains determines the required medium [3]. With the gauge $\mathbf{U}(\mathbf{X}) = \mathbf{u}(\mathbf{x})$, the transformed stiffness keeps its major symmetry but loses its minor symmetries while the density remains scalar [4, 3]. This is a Cosserat-type medium, which ordinary materials do not provide directly. Polar lattices [5] and symmetrised tensors [6] are two routes towards realising or approximating it.

Cylindrical in-plane elastic cloaks built from this gauge have been studied by Brun et al. [4], and a range of cylindrical transformations by Brun and Guenneau [7]. Chatzopoulos et al. [6] compared radial maps for semi-circular carpet cloaks against Rayleigh waves and gave regularised versions of those maps. The singular map sends a point to a circle and requires unbounded material parameters. Replacing the point by a small circle, as in the near-cloak of Kohn et al. [8], removes this singularity; Chatzopoulos et al. [6] use such an offset following Kohn et al. [9].

Before any approximation of the ideal medium can be assessed, the ideal medium itself must be solved accurately, and errors from regularisation, discretisation and the truncation of the domain must be told apart. This is the purpose of the present work. We consider a complete annulus around a traction-free cavity, embedded in the background on all sides, under a localised harmonic force that excites both P and S waves. Our contributions are as follows.

1. An exact equivalence (Theorem 1) between the regularised cloak and a virtual problem with a hole of radius ε. It gives a reference that

separates regularisation error from numerical error, and it shows that the traction conditions follow from the weak form for any increasing C^1 radial map.

2. Proofs of the identities used to verify the model: the polar form of the tensor, the stretched-coordinate PML as a complex push-forward, a closed-form reference for a Gaussian source, superposition of force directions, and a mirror symmetry.
3. A quantified study of the continuous cloak: convergence in ε, sensitivity to mesh and absorbing layer, force direction, source position and frequency.
4. Pixelated cloaks with admissible Cauchy materials (Section 7): the separate costs of pixels and of symmetry, a neural-field parametrisation that is admissible by construction (Proposition 6), an adjoint gradient that reuses one factorisation for all sources, forces and adjoints (Proposition 7), and optimised designs evaluated on held-out sources and frequencies.

The microstructures that would realise the pixel materials are not treated here.

2. Statement of the problem

We consider two-dimensional, time-harmonic, plane-strain elastodynamics with time factor $e^{+\mathrm{i}\omega t}$ (Fig. 1). The background is isotropic with Lamé parameters λ, μ and density ρ, with stiffness

$$C_{ijkl} = \lambda\,\delta_{ij}\delta_{kl} + \mu\,(\delta_{ik}\delta_{jl} + \delta_{il}\delta_{jk}), \tag{1}$$

and wave speeds $c_S = \sqrt{\mu/\rho}$, $c_P = \sqrt{(\lambda+2\mu)/\rho}$. Following Chatzopoulos et al. [6] we take $\lambda = \mu = 144\,\mathrm{MPa}$ and $\rho = 1600\,\mathrm{kg/m^3}$, so that $c_S = 300\,\mathrm{m/s}$ and $c_P = 519.6\,\mathrm{m/s}$.

The geometry is the following. A disk $r < a$ is removed, with $r = \|\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{x}_c\|$, and its entire boundary is traction-free. The cloak occupies the complete annulus $a < r < b$. The circle $r = b$ is a bonded interface with the background, across which displacement and traction are continuous. In the computations $\mathbf{x}_c = \mathbf{0}$, $a = 0.5\,\mathrm{m}$ and $b = 1.5\,\mathrm{m}$.

The excitation is a body force

$$\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}) = F_0\,\hat{\mathbf{d}}\,\frac{g(\mathbf{x})}{\int_\Omega g\,\mathrm{d}\mathbf{x}}, \qquad g(\mathbf{x}) = \exp\!\Big(-\frac{\|\mathbf{x}-\mathbf{x}_s\|^2}{2w^2}\Big), \tag{2}$$

with total force $F_0 = 1000\,\mathrm{N/m}$ per unit thickness and width $w = 0.075\,\mathrm{m}$. The source lies below-left of the cloak, outside $r = b$ and outside the absorbing layer. We use $\mathbf{x}_s = (-3, -3)\,\mathrm{m}$ and $(-3.5, -2)\,\mathrm{m}$, and the unit directions $\hat{\mathbf{d}} = (0, 1)$ (vertical), $(1, 0)$ (horizontal) and $(1, 1)/\sqrt{2}$ (both components in phase). The normalising integral in (2) is computed with the quadrature of the solver, so that the discrete total force equals F_0 on every mesh.

The unbounded medium is truncated to a physical box $[-5, 5]^2\,\mathrm{m}$ surrounded on all four sides by a perfectly matched layer of thickness L (Section 4.1), whose outer edge is clamped. We write Ω_a for the truncated domain without the disk. The field solves

$$\partial_j \big(C^c_{ijkl}\, \partial_l u_k \big) + \omega^2 \rho^c\, u_i + f_i = 0 \quad \text{in } \Omega_a, \tag{3}$$

with $\sigma_{ij} n_j = 0$ on $r = a$ and $\mathbf{u} = \mathbf{0}$ on the outer edge, where $\sigma_{ij} = C^c_{ijkl} \partial_l u_k$. Note that the derivative sits on the second and fourth indices. Coefficients C^c, ρ^c equal the cloak values in the annulus, the PML values in the layer, and the background values elsewhere. Let $V_a = \{ \mathbf{v} \in H^1(\Omega_a)^2 : \mathbf{v} = \mathbf{0}$ on the outer edge$\}$. The weak form reads: find $\mathbf{u} \in V_a$ such that

$$\int_{\Omega_a} \big(C^c_{ijkl}\, \partial_l u_k\, \partial_j v_i - \omega^2 \rho^c\, u_i v_i \big)\, \mathrm{d}\mathbf{x} = \int_{\Omega_a} f_i v_i\, \mathrm{d}\mathbf{x} \qquad \forall\, \mathbf{v} \in V_a. \tag{4}$$

The cavity boundary gives no term in (4), because the traction-free condition is natural, and interface continuity at $r = b$ is contained in the weak form on a conforming mesh.

We compare four cases, with identical source, frequency, domain and layer:

Case A: homogeneous background, no hole.

Case B: traction-free hole $r < a$, no cloak.

Case C: the same hole, surrounded by the regularised cloak of Section 3.

Case D: homogeneous background with a traction-free hole of radius ε (the virtual problem of Theorem 1).

The objective is to quantify how closely C reproduces A outside $r = b$, and to attribute the remaining difference.

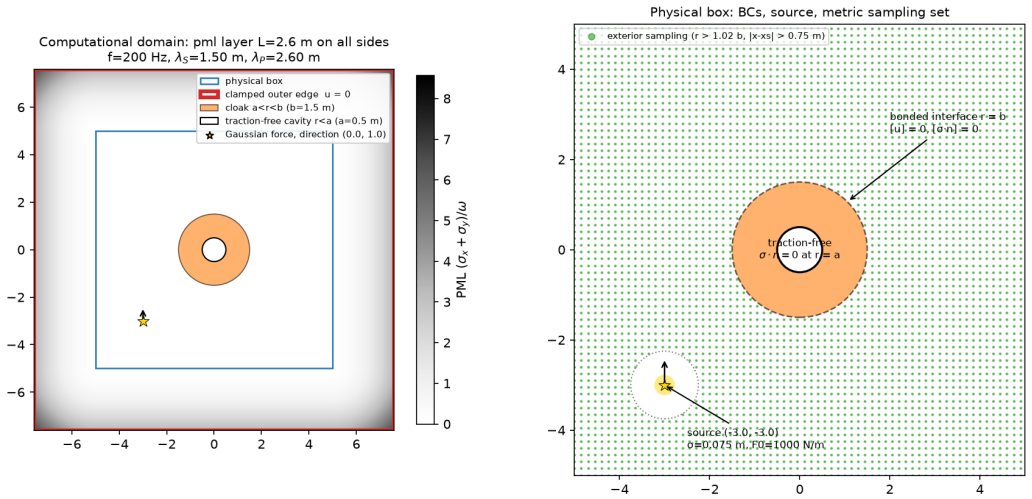


Figure 1: Geometry, boundary conditions, source and sampling points, for source $(-3,-3)$ m and vertical force. Left: the full domain with the PML stretching $(\sigma_x+\sigma_y)/\omega$. Right: the physical box with exterior sampling points (a subset, plotted at 0.15 m spacing) and the excluded source neighbourhood. The label σ in the right panel is the Gaussian width w of (2).

3. The regularised cloak

3.1. Radial maps

Let Ξ map the virtual annulus $\varepsilon \le R \le b$ onto the physical annulus $a \le r \le b$ radially, $r = \phi(R)$, $\theta = \Theta$, with $0 < \varepsilon < a < b$, and let Ξ be the identity for $R \ge b$. We use the linear and quadratic maps of Chatzopoulos et al. [6, Appendix],

$$\phi_1(R) = a + \frac{b-a}{b-\varepsilon}\,(R-\varepsilon), \tag{5}$$

$$\phi_2(R) = A_2 R^2 + A_1 R + A_0, \tag{6}$$

$$A_2 = \frac{a-\varepsilon}{(b-\varepsilon)^2}, \quad A_1 = 1 - \frac{2b(a-\varepsilon)}{(b-\varepsilon)^2}, \quad A_0 = \frac{b^2(a-\varepsilon)}{(b-\varepsilon)^2}.$$

Both satisfy $\phi(\varepsilon) = a$, $\phi(b) = b$. Also $\phi_2'(b) = 1$, and ϕ_2 is increasing on $[\varepsilon, b]$ if and only if $b - \varepsilon > 2(a-\varepsilon)$, as $\phi_2'(\varepsilon) = 1 - 2(a-\varepsilon)/(b-\varepsilon)$. The base case is ϕ_1 with $\varepsilon = 0.005$ m.

Because $\theta = \Theta$, the polar frames at $\mathbf{X}$ and $\mathbf{x}$ coincide, and the transformation gradient $\mathbf{F} = \partial\mathbf{x}/\partial\mathbf{X}$ is

$$\mathbf{F} = F_r\,\mathbf{e}_r \otimes \mathbf{e}_r + F_\theta\,\mathbf{e}_\theta \otimes \mathbf{e}_\theta, \qquad F_r = \phi'(R), \quad F_\theta = \frac{r}{R}, \quad J = \det\mathbf{F} = F_r F_\theta. \tag{7}$$

3.2. The transformed medium

With the gauge $\mathbf{U}(\mathbf{X}) = \mathbf{u}(\mathbf{x})$ [4, 3], the cloak has

$$C'_{ijkl} = J^{-1} F_{jJ} F_{lL}\, C_{iJkL}, \qquad \rho' = \rho\, J^{-1}. \tag{8}$$

This is Eq. (5) of Chatzopoulos et al. [6] after the index transposition $i \leftrightarrow j$, $k \leftrightarrow l$, as that work writes the gradient on the first and third indices. The next theorem is the basis of the validation.

Theorem 1 (Equivalence with the virtual problem). *Let $0 < \varepsilon < a$, and let $\Omega_\varepsilon = \Xi^{-1}(\Omega_a)$ be the truncated domain with the disk $R < \varepsilon$ removed. Assume that $\mathbf{f}$ vanishes in $r < b$. Then $\mathbf{U}$ solves the weak problem on Ω_ε with the background medium in $\varepsilon < R < b$ (case D) if and only if $\mathbf{u} = \mathbf{U} \circ \Xi^{-1}$ solves (4) with (8) in $a < r < b$ (case C). In particular:*

- *(i) $\mathbf{u} = \mathbf{U}$ for $r \geq b$, and $\mathbf{u}(\mathbf{x}) = \mathbf{U}(\Xi^{-1}(\mathbf{x}))$ for $a \leq r \leq b$;*
- *(ii) the traction-free condition on $R = \varepsilon$ corresponds to the traction-free condition on $r = a$;*
- *(iii) the traction is continuous across $r = b$ for any increasing C^1 map ϕ with $\phi(\varepsilon) = a$, $\phi(b) = b$. The condition $\phi'(b) = 1$ is not required for this, although it makes C' continuous at $r = b$.*

Proof. For $\varepsilon > 0$, Ξ is a bi-Lipschitz homeomorphism from Ω_ε onto Ω_a, since ϕ is C^1 and increasing on $[\varepsilon, b]$, $R \geq \varepsilon > 0$, and it is the identity beyond b. Hence composition with Ξ^{-1} is a bijection of V_ε onto V_a preserving the clamped condition. Take $\mathbf{W} \in V_\varepsilon$ and $\mathbf{w} = \mathbf{W} \circ \Xi^{-1}$. The chain rule gives $\partial W_i/\partial X_J = F_{jJ}\,\partial w_i/\partial x_j$, and $\mathrm{d}\mathbf{X} = J^{-1}\mathrm{d}\mathbf{x}$. Therefore, on the annulus,

$$\begin{aligned}
\int_{\varepsilon<R<b} C_{iJkL} \frac{\partial U_k}{\partial X_L} \frac{\partial V_i}{\partial X_J}\,\mathrm{d}\mathbf{X} &= \int_{a<r<b} J^{-1} F_{jJ} F_{lL} C_{iJkL}\,\partial_l u_k\,\partial_j v_i\,\mathrm{d}\mathbf{x} \\
&= \int_{a<r<b} C'_{ijkl}\,\partial_l u_k\,\partial_j v_i\,\mathrm{d}\mathbf{x}, \\
\int_{\varepsilon<R<b} \rho\, U_i V_i\,\mathrm{d}\mathbf{X} &= \int_{a<r<b} \rho'\, u_i v_i\,\mathrm{d}\mathbf{x}.
\end{aligned}$$

Outside the annulus Ξ is the identity and the integrands agree, including the force term, since $\mathbf{f}$ vanishes in $r < b$. So the two bilinear forms and right-hand sides coincide under the bijection, which proves the equivalence and (i).

For the tractions, let $\Sigma_{iJ} = C_{iJkL}\partial U_k/\partial X_L$ and $\sigma'_{ij} = C'_{ijkl}\partial_l u_k$. Then $\sigma'_{ij} = J^{-1}F_{jJ}\Sigma_{iJ}$. Nanson's formula, $n_j\,\mathrm{d}s = J\,F^{-1}_{Kj}N_K\,\mathrm{d}S$, yields

$$\sigma'_{ij}n_j\,\mathrm{d}s = \Sigma_{iK}N_K\,\mathrm{d}S. \tag{9}$$

Since $\mathrm{d}s = F_\theta\,\mathrm{d}S$ on circles and $F_\theta < \infty$, the traction vanishes on $r = a$ if and only if it vanishes on $R = \varepsilon$, which is (ii). On $r = b$ one has $F_\theta = 1$, hence $\mathrm{d}s = \mathrm{d}S$ and $\sigma'_{ij}n_j = \Sigma_{iK}N_K$ from the inside. The virtual field has continuous traction across $R = b$ as the medium there is uniform, and outside Ξ is the identity, which gives (iii). □

Remark 1. *Chatzopoulos et al. [6] derive their quadratic and cubic coefficients from the requirement $\phi'(b) = 1$, described as traction continuity. In the weak formulation above, the linear map gives traction continuity as well, with a jump of C' and ρ' at $r = b$. Our results for the two maps agree (Table 5), which is consistent with both having the same virtual problem.*

The hypothesis on $\mathbf{f}$ holds up to the Gaussian tail: the distance from each source to $r = b$ exceeds $33w$, so $g < e^{-500}$ throughout the cloak. Theorem 1 is why case D is useful. The difference C−D measures implementation and discretisation error, as it vanishes for the exact solutions, whereas D−A is due to ε alone. For $\varepsilon > 0$, case C is therefore a near-cloak: a regularised approximation to the singular limit, not a perfect cloak.

3.3. Polar form

Proposition 1. *Let $g = F_r/F_\theta$. In the orthonormal basis $(\mathbf{e}_r, \mathbf{e}_\theta)$, the only non-zero components of* (8) *for the isotropic background* (1) *are*

$$\begin{gathered} C'_{rrrr} = g\,(\lambda + 2\mu), \quad C'_{\theta\theta\theta\theta} = g^{-1}(\lambda + 2\mu), \quad C'_{rr\theta\theta} = C'_{\theta\theta rr} = \lambda, \\ C'_{r\theta r\theta} = g^{-1}\mu, \quad C'_{\theta r\theta r} = g\,\mu, \quad C'_{r\theta\theta r} = C'_{\theta rr\theta} = \mu. \end{gathered} \tag{10}$$

The Cartesian tensor used by the solver is the full fourth-order rotation $C'_{ijkl} = Q_{ip}Q_{jq}Q_{ks}Q_{lt}C'_{pqst}$ with $\mathbf{Q} = [\mathbf{e}_r \,|\, \mathbf{e}_\theta]$. Moreover:

(a) C' has major symmetry, $C'_{ijkl} = C'_{klij}$;

(b) minor symmetry holds at a point if and only if $g = 1$ there; for the maps used here this occurs only at $r = b$ for ϕ_2;

(c) for every radial map, the 2×2 shear block has zero determinant, and the corresponding null gradient is the image of an infinitesimal rotation.

PROOF. In the polar basis $\mathbf{F} = \mathrm{diag}(F_1, F_2)$ with $F_1 = F_r$, $F_2 = F_\theta$, so (8) gives $C'_{ijkl} = F_j F_l C_{ijkl}/(F_1 F_2)$, without summation. As (1) is isotropic it has the same components in this basis, namely $C_{rrrr} = C_{\theta\theta\theta\theta} = \lambda+2\mu$, $C_{rr\theta\theta} = \lambda$, $C_{r\theta r\theta} = C_{\theta r\theta r} = C_{r\theta\theta r} = \mu$. Substitution gives (10); for example, $C'_{r\theta r\theta} = F_\theta^2\mu/(F_r F_\theta) = \mu/g$. Statement (a) follows by exchanging (i, j) with (k, l) in (8), using the major symmetry of C. For (b), $C'_{r\theta r\theta} - C'_{\theta rr\theta} = \mu(g^{-1} - 1)$. For (c), the block is $\mu\left(\begin{smallmatrix} g^{-1} & 1 \\ 1 & g \end{smallmatrix}\right)$, of determinant zero. For a virtual gradient $\mathbf{G}_X$ the proof of Theorem 1 gives $J\,C'{:}\mathbf{G}_x{:}\mathbf{G}_x = C{:}\mathbf{G}_X{:}\mathbf{G}_X$ with $\mathbf{G}_x = \mathbf{G}_X\mathbf{F}^{-1}$, and the right-hand side vanishes when $\mathbf{G}_X$ is skew. □

For $\varepsilon = 0$ and ϕ_1 one has $g = (r - a)/r$, the form given by Nassar et al. [5]. Dividing (10) by $\rho' = \rho/(F_r F_\theta)$ gives local speeds $F_r c_{P,S}$ radially and $F_\theta c_{P,S}$ tangentially, so that the local radial wavelength is $F_r\lambda_{P,S}$. Under ϕ_1, at $r = a$ one has $F_\theta = a/\varepsilon$, and in the base case $F_r = 0.669$, $F_\theta = 100$, $J = 66.9$, $\rho'/\rho = 0.015$ and $C'_{\theta\theta\theta\theta}/(\lambda + 2\mu) = 149.5$ (Fig. 2).

The near field of the virtual hole has radial extent of order ε, which in physical space is a layer of thickness

$$\delta = \varepsilon\,\phi'(\varepsilon) \tag{11}$$

next to the cavity. The mesh is graded accordingly (Section 4.2).

3.4. Scaling with ε: a formal estimate

By Theorem 1, the exterior error is the scattering of the ε-hole. The following is a formal estimate, not a theorem. For $k\varepsilon \ll 1$, the hole removes mass and stiffness from an area $\pi\varepsilon^2$. To leading order, the exterior perturbation is the field of a point force proportional to $\pi\varepsilon^2\rho\omega^2\mathbf{U}^{\mathrm{inc}}(\mathbf{x}_c)$ and of a force dipole proportional to $\pi\varepsilon^2$ times the incident gradient at $\mathbf{x}_c$. Both scale as ε^2, so we expect $\|\mathbf{u}_D - \mathbf{u}_A\| = O(\varepsilon^2)$ at fixed frequency. For fixed ε and $kr \gg 1$, the point-force contribution relative to the incident field is of order $(k\varepsilon)^2(kr)^{-1/2}$, that is $\propto f^{3/2}$, in view of the far-field decay of the two-dimensional Green tensor. Both trends are compared with the computations in Section 6.

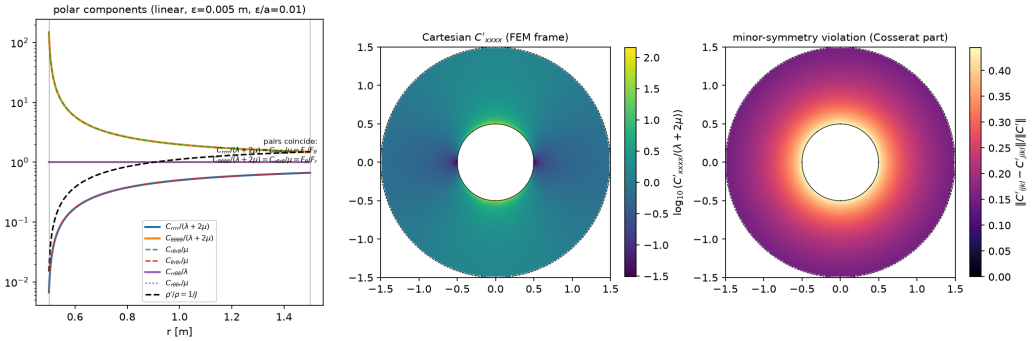


Figure 2: Cloak material for ϕ_1, $\varepsilon/a = 0.01$. Left: polar components (10) and ρ'/ρ. Centre: Cartesian C'_{xxxx}. Right: relative violation of minor symmetry, $\|C'_{ijkl} - C'_{jikl}\|/\|C'\|$.

4. Numerical model

4.1. Perfectly matched layer

Let $d_x, d_y \geq 0$ be the distances into the layer along each axis, and define the stretching

$$s_j = 1 - \mathrm{i}\,\frac{\sigma_j(d_j)}{\omega}, \qquad \sigma_j(d) = \sigma_{\max}\Big(\frac{d}{L}\Big)^p, \qquad \sigma_{\max} = \frac{(p+1)\,c_P \ln(1/R)}{2L}, \tag{12}$$

following the stretched-coordinate form of the PML [10, 11] and its elastodynamic use [12]. We use $L = 2.6\,\mathrm{m}$ ($\approx \lambda_P$ at $f = 200\,\mathrm{Hz}$), $p = 2$ and $R = 10^{-6}$.

Proposition 2. *The stretched coordinates $\tilde{x}_j = x_j - \frac{\mathrm{i}}{\omega}\int_0^{d_j}\sigma_j\,\mathrm{d}d$ applied to the homogeneous medium amount to the push-forward (8) with the complex diagonal $\mathbf{F} = \mathrm{diag}(s_x^{-1}, s_y^{-1})$:*

$$C^c_{ijkl} = C_{ijkl}\,\frac{s_x s_y}{s_j s_l} \quad (\textit{no sum on } j,l), \qquad \rho^c = \rho\, s_x s_y. \tag{13}$$

The resulting bilinear form is complex symmetric. An outgoing plane wave at normal incidence with speed c decays as $\exp(-\int_0^d \sigma\,\mathrm{d}d'/c)$, independently of ω. After reflection at the clamped edge, its amplitude at the interface is the factor $\exp(-2\sigma_{\max}L/((p+1)c))$, which equals R for $c = c_P$ and is smaller for $c = c_S$.

PROOF. The weak form in the variables $\tilde{\mathbf{x}}$ has $\partial/\partial\tilde{x}_j = s_j^{-1}\partial_j$ and $\mathrm{d}\tilde{\mathbf{x}} = s_x s_y\,\mathrm{d}\mathbf{x}$, which gives (13) directly, the same computation as Theorem 1. Symmetry of the bilinear form follows because exchanging (i,j) with (k,l) leaves (13) unchanged. With $k=\omega/c$ and the time factor $e^{+\mathrm{i}\omega t}$, an outgoing wave is $e^{-\mathrm{i}k\tilde{x}} = e^{-\mathrm{i}kx}\exp(-\int\sigma\,\mathrm{d}d'/c)$. The integral over a round trip of the layer is $2\sigma_{\max}L/(p+1)$. □

Proposition 2 concerns exact plane waves; the discrete layer can reflect more, and an oblique wave decays more slowly by the cosine of its angle of incidence, so the layer was tested numerically (Table 4). The formulation is also compared with a graded damping layer, $C \to (1+\mathrm{i}\xi)C$, $\rho \to (1-\mathrm{i}\xi)\rho$, which is absorbing but not matched.

4.2. Discretisation and solver

The weak form (4) is discretised with isoparametric six-node triangles and a six-point quadrature rule, in real arithmetic with four unknowns per node, using JAX-FEM [13] for assembly. The mesh is produced by Gmsh [14] and fragmented into four tagged regions (disk, annulus, physical box, layer), so that the circles $r=a$ and $r=b$ are element edges with mid-side nodes on the true curve. Material is assigned per element region and evaluated at the quadrature points, with no material pixels or cell averaging. Cases A, B and C share all nodes outside $r=a$; A retains the disk elements, and D has its own mesh with the hole at $R=\varepsilon$.

The base element sizes are $h_{\mathrm{bg}} = \lambda_S/16 = 0.094\,\mathrm{m}$ in the background, $h_{\mathrm{bg}}/2$ in the annulus, $h(r{=}a) = 2\delta = 6.7\,\mathrm{mm}$ with δ from (11), graded back over 0.3 m, and $w/2$ at the source (Fig. 3). This gives 82 738 elements and 664 516 real unknowns in case A. Linear systems are factorised with MKL PARDISO, and relative residuals are at most of order 10^{-12}. Since the matrix does not depend on the force, one factorisation serves all force directions (Proposition 4).

4.3. Metrics

All comparisons use a common, mesh-independent set of exterior points: a uniform grid of spacing 0.05 m over the physical box, keeping $r > 1.02\,b$ and $\|\mathbf{x}-\mathbf{x}_s\| > 0.75\,\mathrm{m}$ ($=\lambda_S/2$ at the base frequency), which gives 36 747 points at $\mathbf{x}_s = (-3,-3)\,\mathrm{m}$. Fields are evaluated by exact inversion of the isoparametric map. With the total displacement

$$\|\mathbf{u}\| = \sqrt{|u_x|^2 + |u_y|^2}, \tag{14}$$

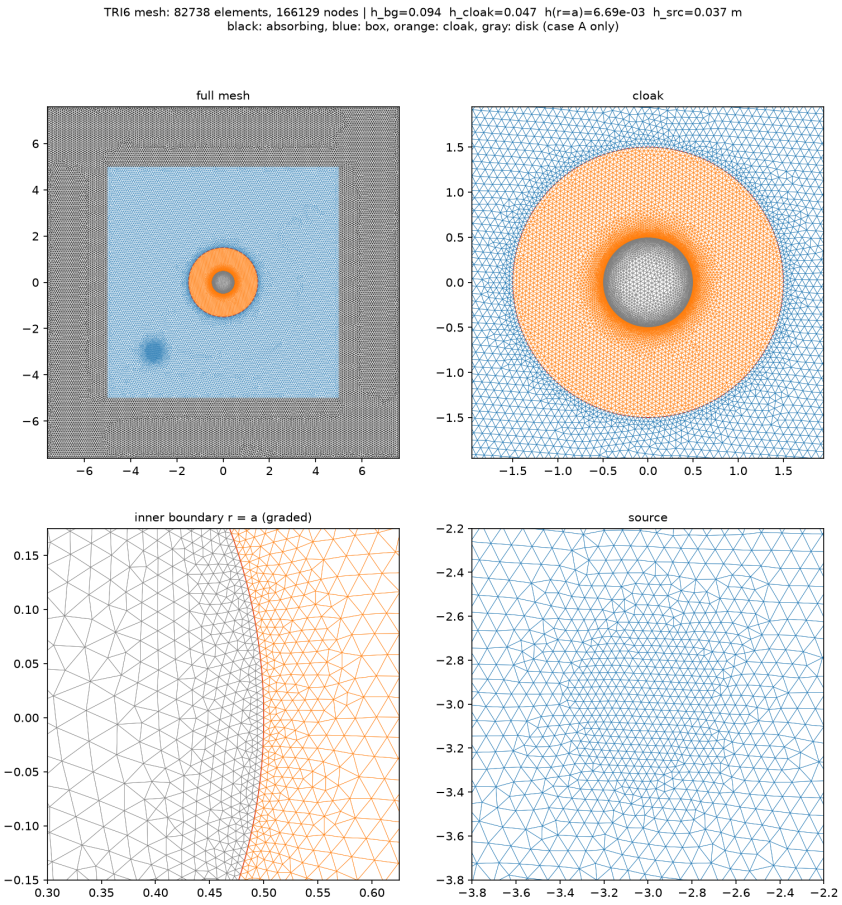


Figure 3: Base mesh: full domain, cloak, graded inner boundary and source neighbourhood.

the primary metric is the normalised error in magnitude, and the secondary metric the complex displacement error:

$$e_X = \frac{\big\| \, \|\mathbf{u}_X\| - \|\mathbf{u}_A\| \, \big\|_2}{\big\| \, \|\mathbf{u}_A\| \, \big\|_2}, \qquad e_X^c = \frac{\|\mathbf{u}_X - \mathbf{u}_A\|_2}{\|\mathbf{u}_A\|_2}. \tag{15}$$

The metric e_X cannot see the phase or direction of $\mathbf{u}$, whereas e_X^c can. In this study e_X^c is about twice e_X. For frequency sweeps, we also report

$$\eta_X = \frac{\langle \|\mathbf{u}_X\| \rangle}{\langle \|\mathbf{u}_A\| \rangle}, \tag{16}$$

with averages over points beyond the cloak as seen from the source, $(\mathbf{x}-\mathbf{x}_c)\cdot\hat{\mathbf{s}} > b$, where $\hat{\mathbf{s}}$ is the unit vector from $\mathbf{x}_s$ to $\mathbf{x}_c$. Then $\eta_A = 1$ by definition.

5. Verification identities

Proposition 3 (Closed-form reference). *In the unbounded homogeneous medium, the solution of* (3) *for the unit-integral Gaussian* (2) *is, up to a term exponentially small in* $\|\mathbf{x}-\mathbf{x}_s\|^2/w^2$,

$$\mathbf{u}(\mathbf{x}) = \frac{F_0}{\mu}\Big[\gamma_S\, g_S\, \hat{\mathbf{d}} + \frac{1}{k_S^2}\nabla\big(\hat{\mathbf{d}}\cdot\nabla(\gamma_S\, g_S - \gamma_P\, g_P)\big)\Big], \tag{17}$$

with $g_\alpha(r_s) = -\frac{\mathrm{i}}{4}H_0^{(2)}(k_\alpha r_s)$, $r_s = \|\mathbf{x}-\mathbf{x}_s\|$, $k_\alpha = \omega/c_\alpha$, $\gamma_\alpha = e^{-k_\alpha^2 w^2/2}$.

Proof. Note that $(\Delta + k^2)g_\alpha = -\delta$ for $k = k_\alpha$, with $H_0^{(2)}$ outgoing for $e^{+\mathrm{i}\omega t}$. Let $\mathcal{L}\mathbf{u} = \mu\Delta\mathbf{u} + (\lambda+\mu)\nabla\nabla\cdot\mathbf{u} + \rho\omega^2\mathbf{u}$. Direct computation gives, for scalar h and constant $\mathbf{d}$,

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{L}(\mathbf{d}\,h) &= \mu\,\mathbf{d}\,(\Delta + k_S^2)h + (\lambda+\mu)\nabla(\mathbf{d}\cdot\nabla h),\\ \mathcal{L}\nabla(\mathbf{d}\cdot\nabla h) &= (\lambda+2\mu)\nabla\big(\mathbf{d}\cdot\nabla(\Delta+k_P^2)h\big).\end{aligned}$$

Take $\mathbf{G}\mathbf{d} = \mu^{-1}[g_S\mathbf{d} + k_S^{-2}\nabla(\mathbf{d}\cdot\nabla(g_S - g_P))]$. Because $(\Delta+k_P^2)(g_S-g_P) = (k_P^2-k_S^2)g_S$ and $(\lambda+2\mu)(k_P^2-k_S^2) = -\rho\omega^2(\lambda+\mu)/\mu = -k_S^2(\lambda+\mu)$, the gradient terms cancel, leaving $\mathcal{L}(\mathbf{G}\mathbf{d}) = -\mathbf{d}\,\delta$. This is the Green tensor for a point force. Convolving with the Gaussian $G_w = g/(2\pi w^2)$, Graf's addition theorem gives, for $\|\mathbf{y}\| < r_s$, $H_0^{(2)}(k\|\mathbf{x}-\mathbf{y}\|) = \sum_n H_n^{(2)}(kr_s)J_n(k\|\mathbf{y}\|)e^{\mathrm{i}n\vartheta}$, with ϑ the angle between $\mathbf{x}$ and $\mathbf{y}$ as seen from $\mathbf{x}_s$. Radial symmetry of G_w retains only $n=0$, and $\int_0^\infty J_0(k\varrho)\,w^{-2}e^{-\varrho^2/2w^2}\,\varrho\,\mathrm{d}\varrho = e^{-k^2w^2/2}$ yields the factors γ_α. The tail with $\|\mathbf{y}\| > r_s$ is exponentially small; at the excluded radius $r_s = 0.75\,\mathrm{m} = 10w$ the Gaussian factor is e^{-50}. □

Proposition 4 (Superposition of force directions). *Assume that the discrete system* $\mathbf{K}(\omega)\mathbf{U} = \mathbf{P}$ *is non-singular, and fix the medium and the position and shape of the source. Let* $\mathbf{u}_H$ *and* $\mathbf{u}_V$ *be the solutions for horizontal and vertical forces. The solution for direction* $\hat{\mathbf{d}} = (d_1, d_2)$ *is then* $\mathbf{u} = d_1\mathbf{u}_H + d_2\mathbf{u}_V$. *In particular,* $\mathbf{u}_{\mathrm{both}} = (\mathbf{u}_H + \mathbf{u}_V)/\sqrt{2}$.

Proof. C^c and ρ^c in (4) do not depend on $\mathbf{u}$ and both boundary conditions are homogeneous, so the left side of (4) is linear in $\mathbf{u}$ and $\mathbf{K}$ is independent of the force. By (2), $\mathbf{f} = d_1\mathbf{f}_H + d_2\mathbf{f}_V$, so $\mathbf{P} = d_1\mathbf{P}_H + d_2\mathbf{P}_V$, and $\mathbf{K}^{-1}$ is linear. □

The problem is linear in the force, not in the material or the frequency. Non-singularity of $\mathbf{K}$ is assumed here, not proved; it is supported by the factorisations and residuals observed in all solves.

Proposition 5 (Mirror symmetry). *Let* $\mathbf{M} = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ *be the reflection in* $y = x$. *Suppose that the box, the layer, the cavity and the cloak are mapped to themselves by* $\mathbf{M}$, *and that* $\mathbf{x}_s = \mathbf{M}\mathbf{x}_s$. *If* $\mathbf{u}_V$ *solves* (4) *with the vertical force, then* $\mathbf{u}_H(\mathbf{x}) = \mathbf{M}\,\mathbf{u}_V(\mathbf{M}\mathbf{x})$ *solves it with the horizontal force. Hence* $\|\mathbf{u}_H(\mathbf{x})\| = \|\mathbf{u}_V(\mathbf{M}\mathbf{x})\|$, *and averages over* $\mathbf{M}$*-invariant sets of points coincide.*

Proof. Write $(T\mathbf{w})(\mathbf{x}) = \mathbf{M}\mathbf{w}(\mathbf{M}\mathbf{x})$. Then T is a bijection of V_a with gradient $\nabla(T\mathbf{w})(\mathbf{x}) = \mathbf{M}(\nabla\mathbf{w})(\mathbf{M}\mathbf{x})\mathbf{M}$. The medium is covariant:

$$C^c_{ijkl}(\mathbf{M}\mathbf{x}) = M_{ip}M_{jq}M_{ks}M_{lt}C^c_{pqst}(\mathbf{x}), \qquad \rho^c(\mathbf{M}\mathbf{x}) = \rho^c(\mathbf{x}).$$

Indeed (1) is invariant, $\mathbf{F}(\mathbf{M}\mathbf{x}) = \mathbf{M}\mathbf{F}(\mathbf{x})\mathbf{M}$ for radial maps, and $\mathbf{M}$ exchanges s_x and s_y in (13). Changing variables $\mathbf{x} \to \mathbf{M}\mathbf{x}$ in (4), of unit Jacobian modulus, shows that the bilinear form is invariant under T. On the right side, $g(\mathbf{M}\mathbf{x}) = g(\mathbf{x})$ and $\mathbf{M}(0,1)^T = (1,0)^T$. □

Hence at $\mathbf{x}_s = (-3,-3)\,\mathrm{m}$, vertical and horizontal forces give the same scalar metrics up to mesh asymmetry; they are not independent tests. The source $(-3.5,-2)\,\mathrm{m}$ removes this symmetry.

6. Results

6.1. Verification

Case A agrees with the closed form (17) to $e = 5.0 \times 10^{-5}$ and $e^c = 2.5 \times 10^{-4}$ on the base mesh, and refinement gives an observed order of about 3.3 with no floor down to the finest level (Table 3). The sign of the force and the time convention are thereby confirmed. Superposition (Proposition 4) holds to round-off: the separately computed solve with $\hat{\mathbf{d}} = (1,1)/\sqrt{2}$ equals $(\mathbf{u}_V + \mathbf{u}_H)/\sqrt{2}$ with e^c between 1.4×10^{-14} and 9.0×10^{-14} over cases A–D and both source positions. Mirror symmetry (Proposition 5) is satisfied to $e^c = 2.6 \times 10^{-4}$, the same order as the mesh error of case A, as expected from a non-symmetric mesh. The material was checked independently: the closed form (7) against automatic differentiation of the map, the Cartesian tensor against the rotated form (10), the symmetries of Proposition 1, invariance of the strain energy for random non-symmetric gradients, and the $\varepsilon = 0$ form of Nassar et al. [5].

6.2. Base case

Table 1 and Figs. 4–6 give the base case with vertical force at $f = 200\,\mathrm{Hz}$, where $\lambda_S = 1.5\,\mathrm{m} = b$ and $\lambda_P = 2.6\,\mathrm{m}$. The bare hole produces strong scattering, $e = 0.158$, with a low-amplitude shadow behind the cavity. In the cloak case, the magnitude agrees with case A outside $r = b$ to $e = 6.7 \times 10^{-5}$, which is about 2400 times smaller. The two terms in the decomposition suggested by Theorem 1 are D vs. A at 7.7×10^{-5} and C vs. D at 1.2×10^{-5}: the residual is dominated by the regularisation, not by the numerics. The mapped interior comparison, of $\mathbf{u}_C(\mathbf{x})$ with $\mathbf{u}_D(\Xi^{-1}(\mathbf{x}))$, confirms part (i) of the theorem within the annulus, at 4.6×10^{-5}.

Table 1: Base case: $\varepsilon/a = 0.01$, linear map, vertical force, source $(-3, -3)\,\mathrm{m}$, $f = 200\,\mathrm{Hz}$. Errors defined in (15).

Comparison	e (magnitude)	e^c (complex)
B: hole without cloak vs. A	1.58×10^{-1}	3.12×10^{-1}
C: regularised cloak vs. A	6.68×10^{-5}	1.30×10^{-4}
C vs. A on the ring $r = 1.25\,b$	1.01×10^{-4}	1.85×10^{-4}
C vs. A on the ring $r = 2\,b$	7.68×10^{-5}	1.38×10^{-4}
D: ε-hole vs. A	7.67×10^{-5}	1.51×10^{-4}
C vs. D, exterior	1.18×10^{-5}	2.61×10^{-5}
$\mathbf{u}_C(\mathbf{x})$ vs. $\mathbf{u}_D(\Xi^{-1}(\mathbf{x}))$, annulus	4.65×10^{-5}	1.25×10^{-4}
A vs. closed form, Eq. (17)	5.00×10^{-5}	2.49×10^{-4}

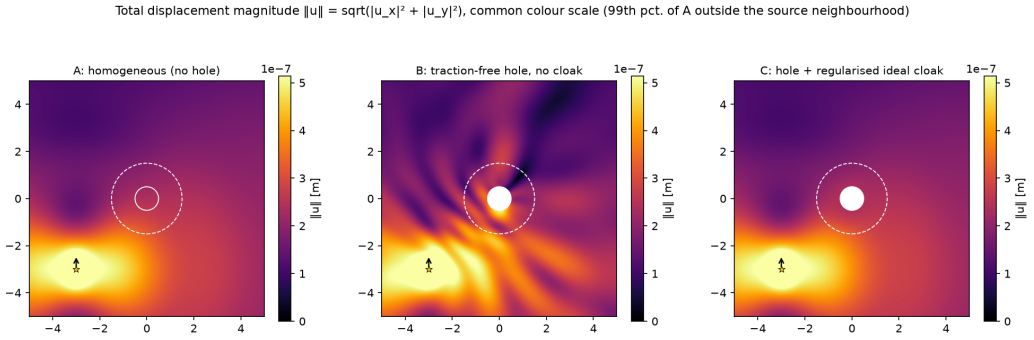


Figure 4: Total displacement magnitude (14) for cases A, B and C on a common colour scale. Base case.

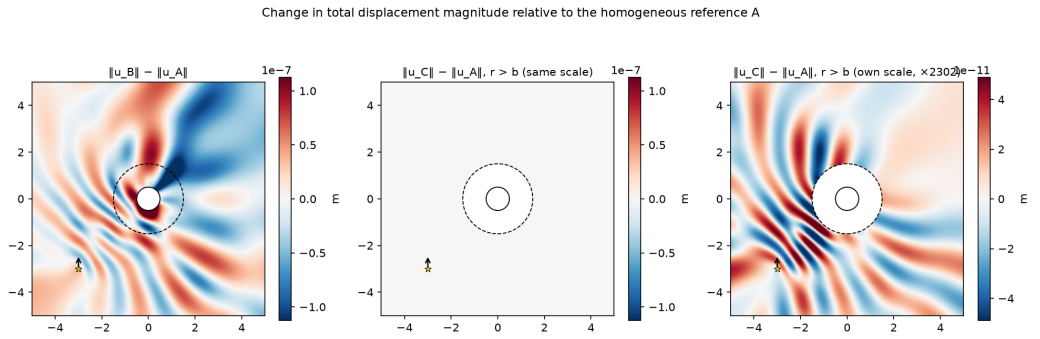


Figure 5: Change in magnitude relative to case A. Left: bare hole. Centre: cloak on the same scale, masked for $r < b$, where the field is the transformed one. Right: cloak on its own scale.

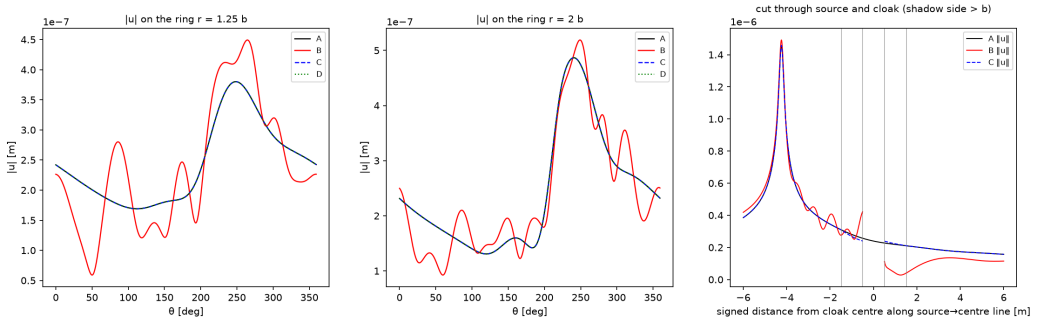


Figure 6: Magnitude on the rings $r = 1.25\,b$ and $r = 2\,b$, and along the line through source and cloak. On the rings, C and D overlap A; on the line, C leaves A only inside $r < b$.

6.3. Convergence in the regularisation

Table 2 and Fig. 7 show the sweep in ε, with $h(r{=}a)$ following (11) below a cap of 20 mm. Between consecutive levels, D vs. A has observed slopes of 1.98–2.02 in ε, in agreement with the estimate of Section 3.4. Case C follows D, and at the smallest value $\varepsilon/a = 0.005$ the error is 1.6×10^{-5}. C vs. D stays between 5×10^{-6} and 1.2×10^{-4} but is not monotone in ε, because the mesh near the cavity changes along the sweep. Results at finite ε approximate the ideal limit; the case $\varepsilon = 0$ itself was not computed.

Table 2: Convergence in the regularisation. Magnitude errors e except for the last column. "Interior" compares $\mathbf{u}_C(\mathbf{x})$ with $\mathbf{u}_D(\Xi^{-1}(\mathbf{x}))$ in the annulus.

ε/a	$h(r{=}a)$ [mm]	C vs. A	D vs. A	C vs. D	interior	C vs. A, e^c
0.2	20.0	3.12×10^{-2}	3.11×10^{-2}	1.21×10^{-4}	3.38×10^{-4}	6.27×10^{-2}
0.1	20.0	7.87×10^{-3}	7.87×10^{-3}	5.34×10^{-6}	3.67×10^{-5}	1.56×10^{-2}
0.05	20.0	1.88×10^{-3}	1.94×10^{-3}	5.78×10^{-5}	1.86×10^{-4}	3.72×10^{-3}
0.02	13.4	2.83×10^{-4}	3.07×10^{-4}	2.74×10^{-5}	1.00×10^{-4}	5.55×10^{-4}
0.01	6.7	6.68×10^{-5}	7.67×10^{-5}	1.18×10^{-5}	4.65×10^{-5}	1.30×10^{-4}
0.005	3.3	1.62×10^{-5}	1.91×10^{-5}	5.05×10^{-6}	2.12×10^{-5}	3.14×10^{-5}

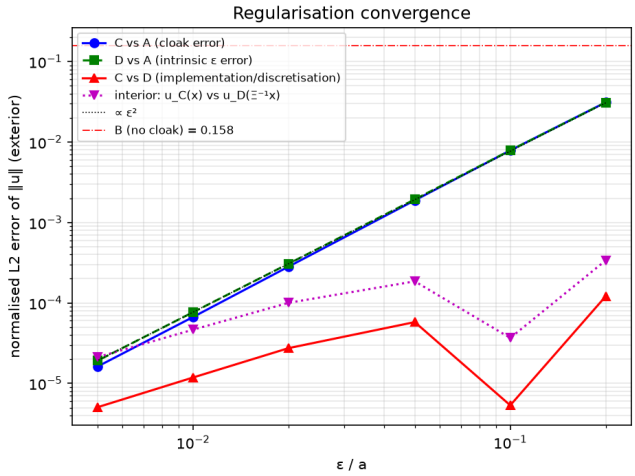


Figure 7: Exterior error against ε/a, for the base case. The dotted line has slope 2.

6.4. Sensitivity to mesh, absorbing layer and radial map

Table 3 and Fig. 8 scale all element sizes together. C vs. A saturates at the regularisation error from about 11 elements per λ_S. C vs. D decreases with refinement, from 4.8×10^{-5} to 9.6×10^{-6}, but its rate falls on the finest levels, so that we cannot state from these data whether it continues to converge at the same rate. Refinement at $r = a$ and quadrature order were not varied separately.

Table 4 varies the absorbing layer. The PML achieves its mesh-limited accuracy with $L \approx \lambda_P$, and is only mildly degraded at $L = 1.5\,\mathrm{m}$, $R = 10^{-4}$. The damping layers are less accurate against the closed form, by a factor of about 9 for the gentler one and more than 100 for the original one, although they are longer. C vs. A is nearly unaffected in all cases, because A, B and C share the layer and its reflections. So that metric alone does

Table 3: Mesh sensitivity with all sizes scaled together. Magnitude errors e.

$\lambda_S/h_{\mathrm{bg}}$	Elements	A vs. closed form	A vs. finest	C vs. A	D vs. A	C vs. D
8.0	21 562	4.84×10^{-4}	4.78×10^{-4}	7.51×10^{-5}	7.46×10^{-5}	4.76×10^{-5}
11.4	43 022	1.52×10^{-4}	1.47×10^{-4}	6.58×10^{-5}	7.62×10^{-5}	1.84×10^{-5}
16.0	82 738	5.00×10^{-5}	4.70×10^{-5}	6.68×10^{-5}	7.67×10^{-5}	1.18×10^{-5}
21.3	144 878	1.92×10^{-5}	ref.	6.83×10^{-5}	7.69×10^{-5}	9.60×10^{-6}

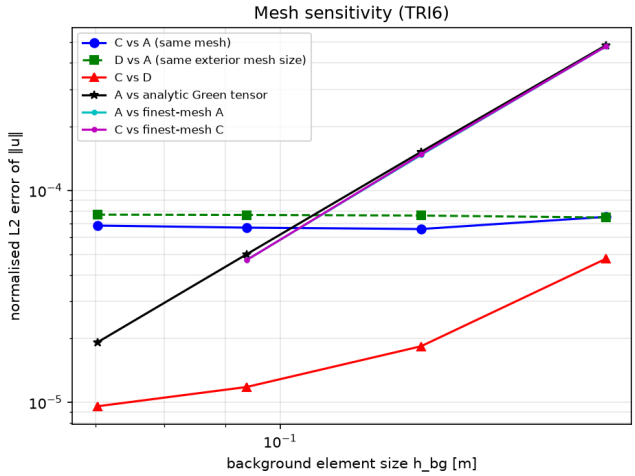


Figure 8: Magnitude errors against the background element size.

not show the accuracy of the absolute field; the comparison with (17) does. Table 5 confirms that linear and quadratic maps perform alike, in line with Theorem 1.

Table 4: Absorbing-layer sensitivity, at $\varepsilon/a = 0.01$.

Layer	Elements	A vs. closed form, e	A vs. closed form, e^c	C vs. A, e
PML, $L = 2.6\,\mathrm{m}$, $R = 10^{-6}$, $p = 2$ (base)	82 738	5.00×10^{-5}	2.49×10^{-4}	6.68×10^{-5}
PML, $L = 1.5\,\mathrm{m}$, $R = 10^{-4}$, $p = 2$	66 080	1.08×10^{-4}	3.04×10^{-4}	6.71×10^{-5}
PML, $L = 4\,\mathrm{m}$, $R = 10^{-6}$, $p = 2$	107 256	5.01×10^{-5}	2.50×10^{-4}	6.71×10^{-5}
PML, $L = 2.6\,\mathrm{m}$, $R = 10^{-4}$, $p = 2$	82 738	6.60×10^{-5}	2.61×10^{-4}	6.68×10^{-5}
PML, $L = 2.6\,\mathrm{m}$, $R = 10^{-8}$, $p = 2$	82 738	4.99×10^{-5}	2.49×10^{-4}	6.68×10^{-5}
PML, $L = 2.6\,\mathrm{m}$, $R = 10^{-6}$, $p = 3$	82 738	5.01×10^{-5}	2.48×10^{-4}	6.68×10^{-5}
damping, $L = 4\,\mathrm{m}$, $\xi_{\max} = 4$, $p = 2$	107 256	1.79×10^{-2}	3.52×10^{-2}	6.64×10^{-5}
damping, $L = 6\,\mathrm{m}$, $\xi_{\max} = 1.5$, $p = 3$	149 054	4.43×10^{-4}	7.42×10^{-4}	6.71×10^{-5}

Table 5: Radial maps, at $\varepsilon/a = 0.01$. Magnitude errors e.

Radial map	C vs. A	D vs. A	C vs. D
linear	6.68×10^{-5}	7.67×10^{-5}	1.18×10^{-5}
quadratic	6.38×10^{-5}	7.67×10^{-5}	1.47×10^{-5}

6.5. Force direction and source position

Table 6 compares all forces at both source positions. At $(-3, -3)$ m, vertical and horizontal coincide, as Proposition 5 requires. At $(-3.5, -2)$ m they are different problems, with bare-hole errors of 0.188 and 0.129, and the cloak reduces the error by a similar factor in each (Fig. 9). The factor B/C lies between about 2360 and 3110 across the six cases.

Table 6: Force direction and source position, at $\varepsilon/a = 0.01$, $f = 200$ Hz. Magnitude errors e.

Source	Force	B vs. A	C vs. A	D vs. A	C vs. D	B/C
$(-3, -3)$	vertical	0.158	6.68×10^{-5}	7.67×10^{-5}	1.18×10^{-5}	2367
$(-3, -3)$	horizontal	0.158	6.67×10^{-5}	7.67×10^{-5}	1.19×10^{-5}	2373
$(-3, -3)$	$(1, 1)/\sqrt{2}$	0.104	3.36×10^{-5}	3.77×10^{-5}	5.12×10^{-6}	3110
$(-3.5, -2)$	vertical	0.188	7.95×10^{-5}	9.12×10^{-5}	1.40×10^{-5}	2361
$(-3.5, -2)$	horizontal	0.129	5.36×10^{-5}	6.13×10^{-5}	8.99×10^{-6}	2414
$(-3.5, -2)$	$(1, 1)/\sqrt{2}$	0.111	4.02×10^{-5}	4.55×10^{-5}	6.24×10^{-6}	2759

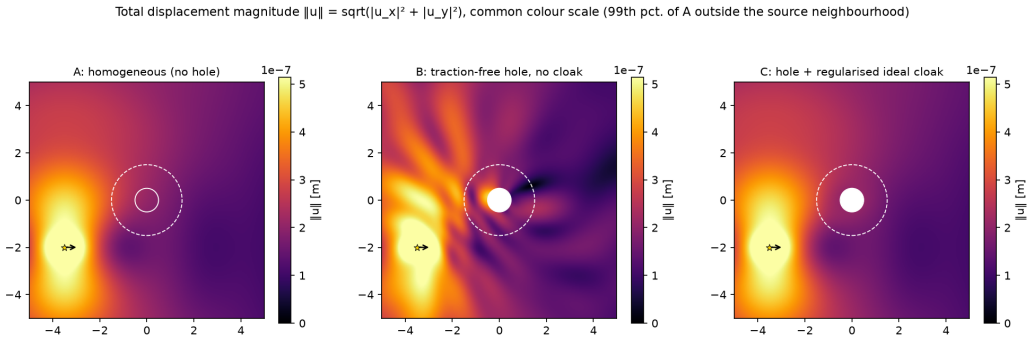


Figure 9: Total displacement magnitude for the source $(-3.5, -2)$ m and horizontal force.

6.6. Frequency sweep

Figures 10–13 and Table 7 show a sweep over $f^* = bf/c_S = b/\lambda_S$ from 0.1 to 2.5 in steps of 0.1 (20–500 Hz), with $\varepsilon/a = 0.01$ fixed and the six combinations of source and force, 150 in total. The background size is $h_{\mathrm{bg}} = \min(0.094\,\mathrm{m}, \lambda_S/10)$, so the mesh is the base mesh up to $f^* = 1.6$ and follows the wavelength above. One factorisation serves the vertical and horizontal forces, and the combined force is obtained from Proposition 4. At $f^* = 1$ the sweep reproduces the values of Table 6 for vertical and horizontal forces.

Over the sweep, $|\eta_C - 1| \le 1.5 \times 10^{-5}$, while e_C stays between 2.3×10^{-6} and 3.2×10^{-4} and the bare hole reaches $e_B = 0.20$. For $0.5 \le f^* \le 1$, the observed exponent of e_C with frequency lies between 1.3 and 1.5, close to the estimate of Section 3.4. Above about $f^* = 1$, e_C is of the same size as the mesh error of case A (at most 2.3×10^{-4} in magnitude), so these data do not separate its growth with frequency from mesh error.

Table 7: Selected points of the sweep, for source $(-3.5, -2)\,\mathrm{m}$; V and H denote vertical and horizontal forces. Magnitude errors e, and ratio η_B from (16). In all these cases η_C differs from 1 by less than 1.6×10^{-5}.

f^*	f [Hz]	η_B (V)	B vs. A (V)	C vs. A (V)	η_B (H)	B vs. A (H)	C vs. A (H)
0.1	20	0.983	0.027	2.3×10^{-6}	0.985	0.038	3.1×10^{-6}
0.4	80	0.902	0.162	1.9×10^{-5}	0.972	0.119	1.5×10^{-5}
0.5	100	0.869	0.170	2.7×10^{-5}	0.953	0.107	1.9×10^{-5}
1	200	0.854	0.188	7.9×10^{-5}	0.876	0.129	5.4×10^{-5}
1.5	300	0.808	0.200	1.5×10^{-4}	0.841	0.134	9.0×10^{-5}
2	400	0.821	0.200	2.2×10^{-4}	0.840	0.138	1.5×10^{-4}
2.5	500	0.800	0.202	3.2×10^{-4}	0.825	0.142	2.0×10^{-4}

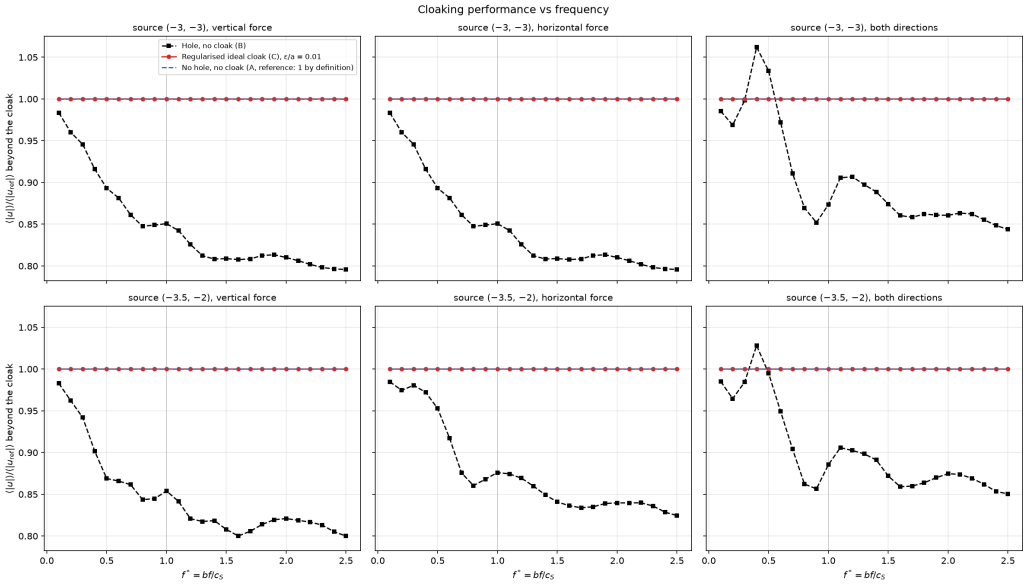


Figure 10: Ratio η of (16) against frequency, beyond the cloak. Case A is 1 by definition; C overlaps it.

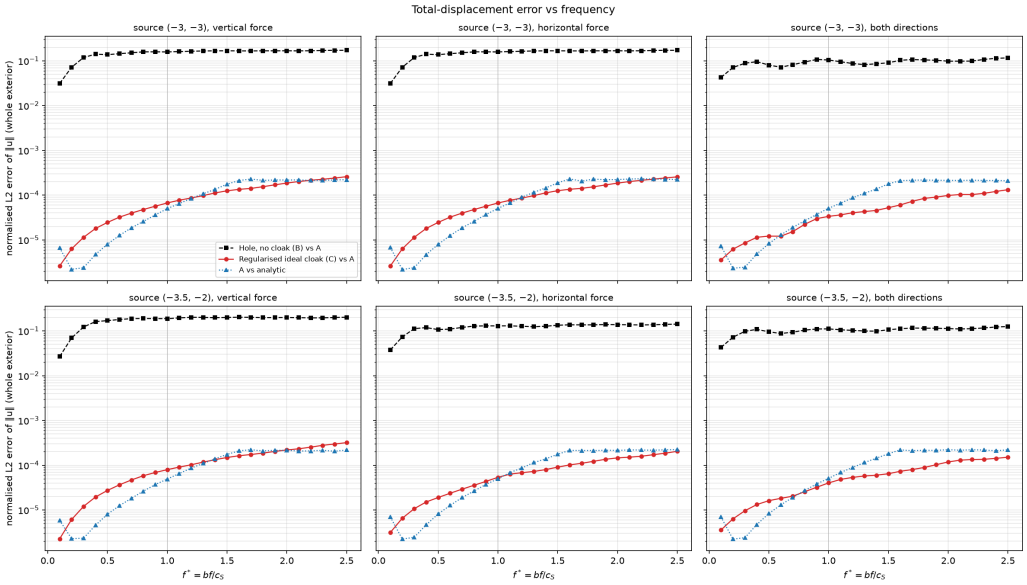


Figure 11: Magnitude error over the whole exterior against frequency.

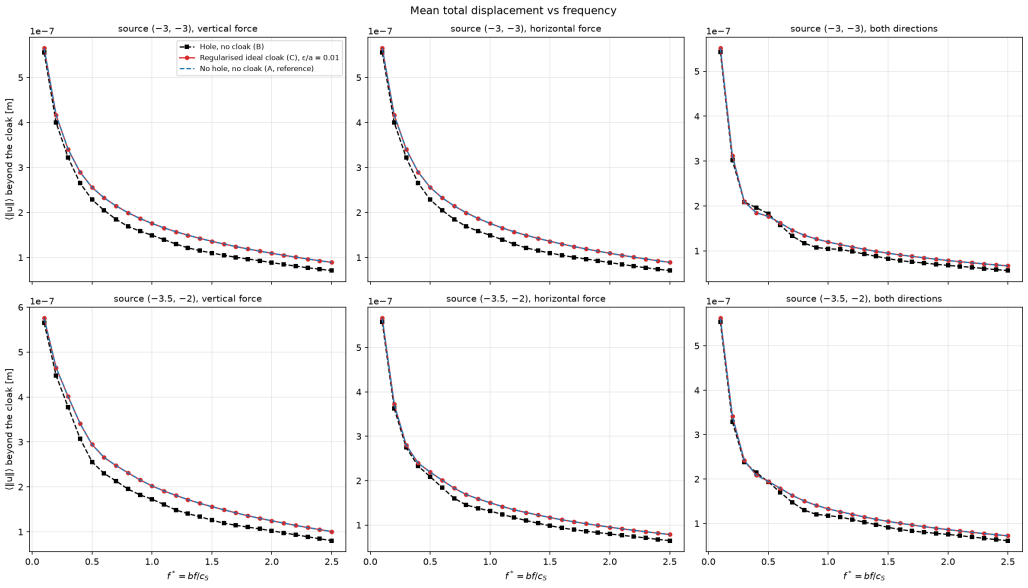


Figure 12: Absolute mean total displacement beyond the cloak against frequency. Curves A and C overlap.

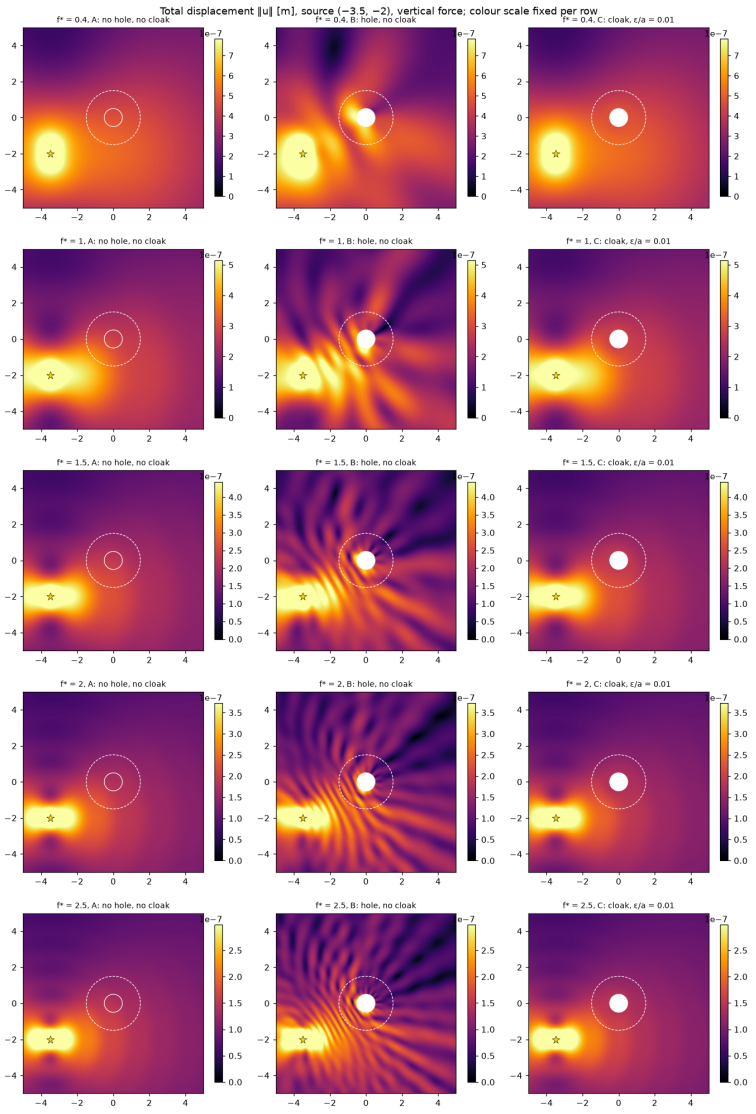


Figure 13: Total displacement at $f^* = 0.4, 1, 1.5, 2, 2.5$ for the source $(-3.5, -2)$ m and vertical force. Columns: A, B, C. Colour scale fixed per row.

6.7. Why the ratio can exceed one

The bare-hole ratio is not bounded by 1. For $\hat{\mathbf{d}} = (1,1)/\sqrt{2}$ at source $(-3,-3)\,\mathrm{m}$, it reaches $\eta_B = 1.062$ at $f^* = 0.4$, with a smaller peak of 1.028 at $(-3.5,-2)\,\mathrm{m}$ (Fig. 10). This is not a numerical artefact, since A agrees with the closed form to about 5×10^{-6} there, and C stays at 1. To explain it, write $\mathbf{u}_{\mathrm{sc}} = \mathbf{u}_B - \mathbf{u}_A$ and use

$$\|\mathbf{u}_B\|^2 - \|\mathbf{u}_A\|^2 = \|\mathbf{u}_{\mathrm{sc}}\|^2 + 2\,\mathrm{Re}\big(\mathbf{u}_A^* \cdot \mathbf{u}_{\mathrm{sc}}\big). \tag{18}$$

Table 8 evaluates the two terms beyond the cloak. Scattered fields of comparable size add a similar energy for both forces. The difference at $f^* = 0.4$ lies in the interference: -0.276 for the vertical force, which forms a shadow, but only $+0.001$ for the combined force, whose scattered energy simply adds. In that case the force points along the source–cloak axis, near which the S radiation of a point force is weak, so the reference field is dominated by P waves (64% of the energy) and is about one third smaller. A plausible reason for the absence of the shadow is the long P wavelength, $\lambda_P = 6.5\,\mathrm{m}$, relative to the 1 m hole, but we did not isolate this cause. At $f^* = 1$, interference becomes strong in both cases and $\eta_B < 1$.

There is no conflict with energy conservation, since η is a mean amplitude over one region and not a flux. More generally, η is a weak metric for embedded cavities: it remains within about 20% of 1 here, while the error e_B reaches 0.20 and the maps of Fig. 13 show strong scattering. We therefore regard e as the primary evidence.

Table 8: Decomposition (18) beyond the cloak for the bare hole at source $(-3,-3)\,\mathrm{m}$, where the off-axis distance is $d_\perp$.

	$f^* = 0.4$, V	$f^* = 0.4$, both	$f^* = 1$, V	$f^* = 1$, both
η_B beyond the cloak	0.916	1.062	0.851	0.874
near the axis, $\lvert d_\perp\rvert < 2\,\mathrm{m}$	0.795	1.024	0.713	0.837
to the sides, $\lvert d_\perp\rvert \geq 2\,\mathrm{m}$	1.091	1.102	1.047	0.913
P share of the energy of $\mathbf{u}_A$	0.16	0.64	0.17	0.67
$\langle\|\mathbf{u}_A\|\rangle$ $[10^{-7}\,\mathrm{m}]$	2.90	1.85	1.76	1.20
scattered energy $\langle\|\mathbf{u}_{\mathrm{sc}}\|^2\rangle/\langle\|\mathbf{u}_A\|^2\rangle$	$+0.153$	$+0.158$	$+0.347$	$+0.259$
interference $2\langle\mathrm{Re}\,\mathbf{u}_A^*\cdot\mathbf{u}_{\mathrm{sc}}\rangle/\langle\|\mathbf{u}_A\|^2\rangle$	-0.276	$+0.001$	-0.574	-0.441

7. Pixelated cloaks with admissible Cauchy materials

The ideal medium varies continuously and breaks minor symmetry (Proposition 1). We now ask what is lost, and what optimisation can recover,

when the cloak is built from a limited number of uniform pixels of ordinary (Cauchy) material. Unless stated otherwise, the radial map is ϕ_2, $\varepsilon/a = 0.01$ and the mesh, source shape and metrics are those of the previous sections.

7.1. Pixels and admissible materials

A polar grid of $n_\theta \times n_r$ pixels, uniform in θ and in r, covers $a < r < b$. Each pixel p carries one stiffness tensor $C^{(p)}$ and one density $\rho^{(p)}$. The pixel of a quadrature point is found from its coordinates, so the pixel grid is independent of the mesh, while the cavity and the circle $r = b$ remain exact mesh edges. We use 50×10, 36×7, 24×5 and 15×4 pixels, i.e. 500, 252, 120 and 60; every pixel contains quadrature points, so all are active. A Cauchy material has $C_{ijkl} = C_{jikl} = C_{klij}$, so that $\boldsymbol{\sigma} = C : \nabla\mathbf{u} = C : \boldsymbol{\varepsilon}$, and is admissible if its strain energy is positive. With $\mathbf{v} = (\varepsilon_{11}, \varepsilon_{22}, 2\varepsilon_{12})$ the energy is $\mathbf{v}^T\mathbf{M}\mathbf{v}$, with the Voigt matrix

$$\mathbf{M} = \begin{pmatrix} C_{1111} & C_{1122} & C_{1112} \\ C_{1122} & C_{2222} & C_{2212} \\ C_{1112} & C_{2212} & C_{1212} \end{pmatrix}, \tag{19}$$

so admissibility means $\mathbf{M}$ positive definite and $\rho > 0$.

7.2. Pixelisation and symmetry without optimisation

Before optimising, we sample the validated ideal tensor into pixels, either at the pixel centre or as the area average over an 8×8 sub-grid, and symmetrise it by the arithmetic mean $C^{\mathrm{sym}}_{ijkl} = \frac{1}{4}(C'_{ijkl} + C'_{jikl} + C'_{ijlk} + C'_{jilk})$ used in Chatzopoulos et al. [6]. Table 9 and Fig. 14 give the worst error over the six combinations of the two Step 1 sources with the three forces, at $f^* = 1$.

Pixels alone cost little. With 500 pixels the ideal tensor sampled at the centres gives $e = 1.6 \times 10^{-2}$ for ϕ_2 and 4.2×10^{-3} for ϕ_1, against 0.188 for the hole. Symmetry costs far more: the symmetrised continuous cloak gives 0.200 and 0.222, no better than the hole, and the symmetrised pixels are similar at every pixel count. So, at this frequency and with bulk excitation, the arithmetic-mean symmetrisation does not produce a useful cloak. This is consistent with the poor performance of symmetrised cloaks near $f^* = 1$, in their normalisation, reported by Chatzopoulos et al. [6] for Rayleigh waves, a different setting.

Table 9: Pixels and symmetry without optimisation: worst e over two sources and three forces, $f^{*}=1$.

Map	Material	Pixels	worst e
linear	hole without cloak	–	1.88×10^{-1}
linear	ideal, continuous	–	7.95×10^{-5}
linear	symmetrised, continuous	–	2.22×10^{-1}
linear	ideal pixels, centre / average	500	4.18×10^{-3} / 1.34×10^{-2}
linear	symmetrised pixels, average	500	2.22×10^{-1}
linear	ideal pixels, centre / average	252	9.31×10^{-3} / 2.28×10^{-2}
linear	symmetrised pixels, average	252	2.23×10^{-1}
linear	ideal pixels, centre / average	120	2.01×10^{-2} / 3.83×10^{-2}
linear	symmetrised pixels, average	120	2.25×10^{-1}
linear	ideal pixels, centre / average	60	3.13×10^{-2} / 6.60×10^{-2}
linear	symmetrised pixels, average	60	2.30×10^{-1}
quadratic	hole without cloak	–	1.88×10^{-1}
quadratic	ideal, continuous	–	7.59×10^{-5}
quadratic	symmetrised, continuous	–	2.00×10^{-1}
quadratic	ideal pixels, centre / average	500	1.57×10^{-2} / 3.21×10^{-2}
quadratic	symmetrised pixels, average	500	2.02×10^{-1}
quadratic	ideal pixels, centre / average	252	3.37×10^{-2} / 4.79×10^{-2}
quadratic	symmetrised pixels, average	252	2.05×10^{-1}
quadratic	ideal pixels, centre / average	120	6.40×10^{-2} / 6.65×10^{-2}
quadratic	symmetrised pixels, average	120	2.08×10^{-1}
quadratic	ideal pixels, centre / average	60	1.03×10^{-1} / 8.81×10^{-2}
quadratic	symmetrised pixels, average	60	2.10×10^{-1}

7.3. Neural-field parametrisation

The design is a coordinate network, reusing the multilayer perceptron of the group's earlier pipeline. Each pixel centre, with $\hat{r}=(r-a)/(b-a)$, is encoded by $\hat{r}$, $\cos(k\pi\hat{r})$, $\sin(k\pi\hat{r})$ for $k\le4$, $\cos m\theta$, $\sin m\theta$ for $m\le8$, and the products of the first three radial features with the angular ones: 73 features. Three hidden layers of 128 units with tanh give 7 outputs $y^{(p)}$, for 43 399 parameters. With $\mathbf{L}_0^{(p)}$ the Cholesky factor of the scaled symmetrised initial matrix $\mathbf{M}_0^{(p)}/\mu$ and $s=0.1$,

$$
\begin{aligned}
L_{ii}^{(p)} = L_{0,ii}^{(p)}\,e^{s y_{ii}}, \qquad L_{ij}^{(p)} = L_{0,ij}^{(p)} + s\,y_{ij}\sqrt{L_{0,ii}^{(p)}L_{0,jj}^{(p)}}\ (i>j),\\
\mathbf{M}^{(p)} = \mu\,\mathbf{L}^{(p)}\mathbf{L}^{(p)T}, \qquad \rho^{(p)} = \rho_0^{(p)}e^{s y_7},
\end{aligned}
\tag{20}
$$

with y_{ij} six of the outputs. The last layer starts at zero, so the initial design is exactly the symmetrised pixel cloak.

Proposition 6 (Admissibility). *For all network parameters, every pixel material defined by* (19)–(20) *is minor- and major-symmetric with positive-definite* $\mathbf{M}^{(p)}$*, and* $\rho^{(p)} > 0$*.*

PROOF. $\mathbf{L}^{(p)}$ is lower triangular with positive diagonal, hence non-singular, so $\mathbf{M}^{(p)} = \mu \mathbf{L}^{(p)} \mathbf{L}^{(p)T}$ is symmetric positive definite. The tensor is rebuilt from the six entries of $\mathbf{M}^{(p)}$ by assigning each to all of its minor and major partners, so both symmetries hold by construction. The exponential is positive. □

The constraint is exact, not penalised, so no design produced during optimisation leaves the admissible set. It does not bound the contrast between pixels.

7.4. Loss, adjoint gradient and cost

Sources are split into three groups, all on one mesh refined around every source. The eight training sources lie on the circle $r = 3.5\,\mathrm{m}$ at $22.5° + 45°k$. The four validation sources, at $(\pm 2.5, 0)$ and $(0, \pm 4.5)\,\mathrm{m}$, select the best design. The four test sources, $(-3, -3)$, $(-3.5, -2)$, $(3, 3)$ and $(2.2, -1.5)\,\mathrm{m}$, which include both Step 1 sources, take no part in training or selection. Both force directions are used, which by Proposition 4 spans all in-plane forces. For the right-hand sides k of the training sources, the loss is

$$\mathcal{J} = \frac{1}{K} \sum_{k=1}^{K} \frac{\|\mathbf{P}(\mathbf{u}_k - \mathbf{u}_{A,k})\|_{T_k}^2}{\|\mathbf{P}\mathbf{u}_{A,k}\|_{T_k}^2}, \tag{21}$$

where $\mathbf{P}$ evaluates the field at the exterior points of Section 4 and T_k is a fixed random half of those outside the neighbourhood of the source; the other half is held out. The reference $\mathbf{u}_{A,k}$ is case A on the same exterior mesh, so that the discretisation error cancels.

Proposition 7 (Adjoint gradient). *Let* $\mathbf{K}(\theta)\mathbf{u} = \mathbf{b}$ *be the real form, restricted to free degrees of freedom, of the complex system from* (4)*, with the material depending on parameters* θ*, and let* $\mathbf{g} = \partial \mathcal{J} / \partial \mathbf{u}$*. Then*

$$\frac{\mathrm{d}\mathcal{J}}{\mathrm{d}\theta} = -\boldsymbol{\lambda}^T \frac{\partial \mathbf{K}}{\partial \theta} \mathbf{u}, \qquad \mathbf{K}^T \boldsymbol{\lambda} = \mathbf{g}, \qquad \mathbf{K}^T = \mathbf{S}\mathbf{K}\mathbf{S}, \tag{22}$$

with $\mathbf{S}$ *diagonal,* $+1$ *on real and* -1 *on imaginary unknowns, so that* $\boldsymbol{\lambda} = \mathbf{S}\mathbf{K}^{-1}\mathbf{S}\mathbf{g}$ *uses the forward factorisation. For a quadrature point* q *of weight* w_q *in the annulus, with* $\mathbf{u} = \mathbf{u}^R + \mathrm{i}\mathbf{u}^I$ *and* $\boldsymbol{\lambda}$ *split likewise,*

$$\begin{aligned} \boldsymbol{\lambda}^T \frac{\partial \mathbf{K}}{\partial C_{ijkl}(q)} \mathbf{u} &= w_q \big(\partial_j \lambda_i^R \, \partial_l u_k^R + \partial_j \lambda_i^I \, \partial_l u_k^I \big), \\ \boldsymbol{\lambda}^T \frac{\partial \mathbf{K}}{\partial \rho(q)} \mathbf{u} &= -\omega^2 w_q \big(\boldsymbol{\lambda}^R \cdot \mathbf{u}^R + \boldsymbol{\lambda}^I \cdot \mathbf{u}^I \big). \end{aligned} \tag{23}$$

Proof. Differentiating $\mathbf{K}\mathbf{u} = \mathbf{b}$, with $\mathbf{b}$ independent of θ, gives $\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{d}\mathbf{u} = -(\partial\mathbf{K}/\partial\theta)\mathbf{u}$, so $\mathrm{d}\mathcal{J} = \mathbf{g}^T \mathrm{d}\mathbf{u} = -\boldsymbol{\lambda}^T(\partial\mathbf{K}/\partial\theta)\mathbf{u}$ with $\mathbf{K}^T\boldsymbol{\lambda} = \mathbf{g}$. The bilinear form of (4) is symmetric without conjugation, because $C^c_{ijkl} = C^c_{klij}$ (Proposition 2) and ρ^c is scalar; so the complex matrix $\mathbf{A} + \mathrm{i}\mathbf{B}$ has $\mathbf{A}^T = \mathbf{A}$, $\mathbf{B}^T = \mathbf{B}$. Its real form is $\mathbf{K} = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} \mathbf{A} & -\mathbf{B} \\ \mathbf{B} & \mathbf{A} \end{smallmatrix}\right)$, whose transpose is $\left(\begin{smallmatrix} \mathbf{A} & \mathbf{B} \\ -\mathbf{B} & \mathbf{A} \end{smallmatrix}\right) = \mathbf{S}\mathbf{K}\mathbf{S}$. Restricting to free unknowns keeps the identity, since Dirichlet unknowns are removed from rows and columns alike. Finally, in the annulus the real and imaginary parts decouple and the weak form is linear in C and ρ, which gives (23) at each quadrature point. The gradient with respect to θ follows by the chain rule through (20). □

The implementation was checked against central finite differences of $\mathcal{J}$ (relative agreement within 10^{-5} for the complex and the magnitude loss), against reverse-mode differentiation of the JAX-FEM residual (within 10^{-8}), and the adjoint satisfies $\mathbf{K}^T\boldsymbol{\lambda} = \mathbf{g}$ to 10^{-8}. The matrix depends on neither source nor force, so at each frequency one factorisation serves the 16 training and 8 validation right-hand sides and the 16 adjoint solves. All frequencies up to $f^* \approx 1.6$ share the base mesh; a problem built at ω_0 gives the one at ω by scaling the density by $(\omega/\omega_0)^2$ and recomputing the PML coefficients (13), which is exact.

We minimise $\mathcal{J}$ with Adam and a cosine learning-rate decay from 2×10^{-3} to 2×10^{-4} over 600 steps. On a 12-core CPU, a step costs about 18–20 s with eight training sources at one frequency and 51 s at three frequencies. The frequency-pool run draws two of eleven frequencies $f^* \in \{0.5, 0.6, \ldots, 1.5\}$ per step (33–40 s per step), starts from the three-frequency design, and ran 1500 steps with a rate decaying from 10^{-3} to 10^{-4}, then 1500 more from 1.3×10^{-4} to 5×10^{-5}.

7.5. Results

One training source is not enough. A first design trained on a single source reached $e \approx 6 \times 10^{-3}$ on it, but only 0.10–0.12 on another, unseen source

(Table 10), against 0.16 for the hole. Held-out points of the trained source did not reveal this, since they belong to the same field. All further runs use the eight training sources and report test sources.

Table 10: Design trained on one source only, $f^* = 1$, 500 pixels, 150 steps.

Source	Force	e	e^c
$(-3, -3)$, not trained	vertical	9.61×10^{-2}	1.92×10^{-1}
$(-3, -3)$, not trained	horizontal	1.19×10^{-1}	2.38×10^{-1}
$(-3, -3)$, not trained	both	4.69×10^{-2}	1.16×10^{-1}
$(-3.5, -2)$, trained	vertical	5.91×10^{-3}	1.16×10^{-2}
$(-3.5, -2)$, trained	horizontal	6.14×10^{-3}	1.13×10^{-2}
$(-3.5, -2)$, trained	both	5.62×10^{-3}	1.19×10^{-2}

Single frequency. Table 11 summarises all runs. At $f^* = 1$ the 500-pixel design gives a test median of 0.042 and a worst value of 0.053, against 0.158 and 0.263 for the hole: a factor of 3.8 and 5.0. The error rises gradually with fewer pixels, to a median of 0.057, 0.065 and 0.099 for 252, 120 and 60 pixels. After optimisation the quadratic map is better than the linear one (0.042 against 0.049), the reverse of the ranking for unoptimised ideal pixels. Figure 14 places the optimised designs among the baselines: optimisation recovers most of what symmetrisation loses (from 0.202 to 0.044 at 500 pixels), but stays above the non-admissible ideal pixels (0.016 and 0.032). At 60 pixels the optimised Cauchy design matches the ideal pixels. Every run except the 60-pixel one was still improving when stopped (Fig. 18).

Table 11: Optimised designs at $f^* = 1$: median and worst e over the four test sources and three forces, and the worst over the two Step 1 sources for comparison with Table 9. The bare hole gives 0.158 (median) and 0.263 (worst) on the test sources.

Run	Training f^*	Pixels	Map	Steps	train, median	test, median	test, worst	Step 1 sources, worst
f1_500	1	500	quadratic	600	0.026	0.042	0.053	0.044
f1_500_linear	1	500	linear	600	0.031	0.049	0.075	0.062
f1_252	1	252	quadratic	600	0.033	0.057	0.072	0.061
f1_120	1	120	quadratic	600	0.037	0.065	0.083	0.072
f1_60	1	60	quadratic	600	0.090	0.099	0.131	0.102
band_500	0.5, 1, 1.5	500	quadratic	600	0.090	0.086	0.170	0.097
pool_500	pool [0.5, 1.5]	500	quadratic	3000	0.077	0.069	0.140	0.105

Frequency. Table 12 and Fig. 15 evaluate the designs across frequency. The single-frequency design is the best at $f^* = 1$ but worse than the hole at

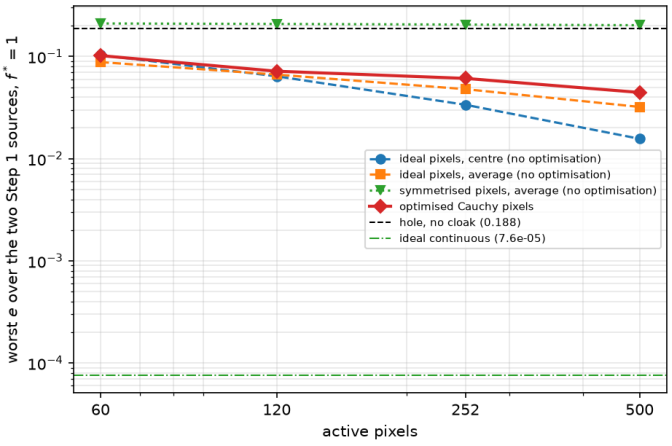


Figure 14: Worst e over the two Step 1 sources at $f^* = 1$ against the number of pixels, for unoptimised ideal and symmetrised pixels and for the optimised Cauchy designs.

$f^* = 1.5$ and 2. Training at three fixed frequencies helps at those frequencies but leaves peaks between them (0.126 at $f^* = 0.75$, 0.141 at 1.25). Drawing two of eleven frequencies per step removes the peaks: across $0.5 \le f^* \le 1.5$ the median is 0.067–0.119 and the worst value 0.103–0.179, against 0.138–0.168 and 0.222–0.278 for the hole, so the median is 1.4 to 2.3 times lower. The price is the performance at a single frequency (0.069 against 0.042 at $f^* = 1$). Just above the band, at $f^* = 1.75$, the median rises to 0.180; the hole was not computed there, and $f^* = 2$ was not evaluated for this design (memory limit).

Designs and fields. Figure 16 shows the pixel materials in the local polar frame. The optimised designs keep the large tangential stiffness of the transformation near the cavity but add strong coupling terms and a non-radial pattern; the problem is rotationally symmetric, but nothing in the parametrisation or in the eight-source training imposes that symmetry. The contrast is large: the eigenvalues of $\mathbf{M}^{(p)}$ span 0.13μ to 311μ for the single-frequency design and 0.04μ to 786μ for the pool design, and the density $0.70\rho_0$ to $2.1\rho_0$ and $0.21\rho_0$ to $3.2\rho_0$. Figure 17 shows the fields at an unseen source: both designs suppress most of the shadow and scattering of the hole at $f^* = 1$, while at $f^* = 1.5$ only the pool design does.

Limitations of the optimisation results. The designs are not converged, only one geometry and one mesh were used, the source groups contain four test

Table 12: Median / worst e on the test sources against frequency, 500 pixels. The pool design was trained on $f^* \in [0.5, 1.5]$.

f^*	hole, no cloak	single frequency	three frequencies	frequency pool
0.5	0.138 / 0.222	0.106 / 0.189	0.074 / 0.120	0.071 / 0.115
0.6	–	–	–	0.079 / 0.124
0.75	0.155 / 0.278	–	0.126 / 0.239	0.075 / 0.132
0.9	–	–	–	0.067 / 0.103
1	0.158 / 0.263	0.042 / 0.053	0.086 / 0.170	0.069 / 0.140
1.1	–	–	–	0.077 / 0.178
1.25	0.165 / 0.266	–	0.141 / 0.236	0.092 / 0.179
1.4	–	–	–	0.109 / 0.156
1.5	0.168 / 0.253	0.214 / 0.353	0.106 / 0.211	0.119 / 0.175
1.75	–	–	–	0.180 / 0.307
2	0.168 / 0.255	0.235 / 0.380	0.221 / 0.343	–

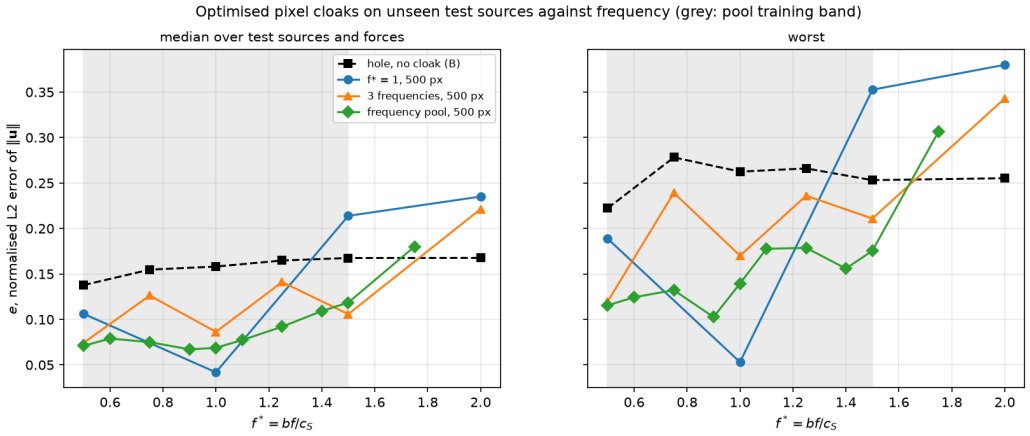


Figure 15: Error on the test sources against frequency for the bare hole and three optimised 500-pixel designs.

positions only, and the networks, learning rates and source layout were not tuned. The test sources lie at radii between 2.7 and 4.2 m; generalisation to other distances was not tested. The pixel materials are unconstrained in contrast and anisotropy, and their realisation by microstructures has not been studied.

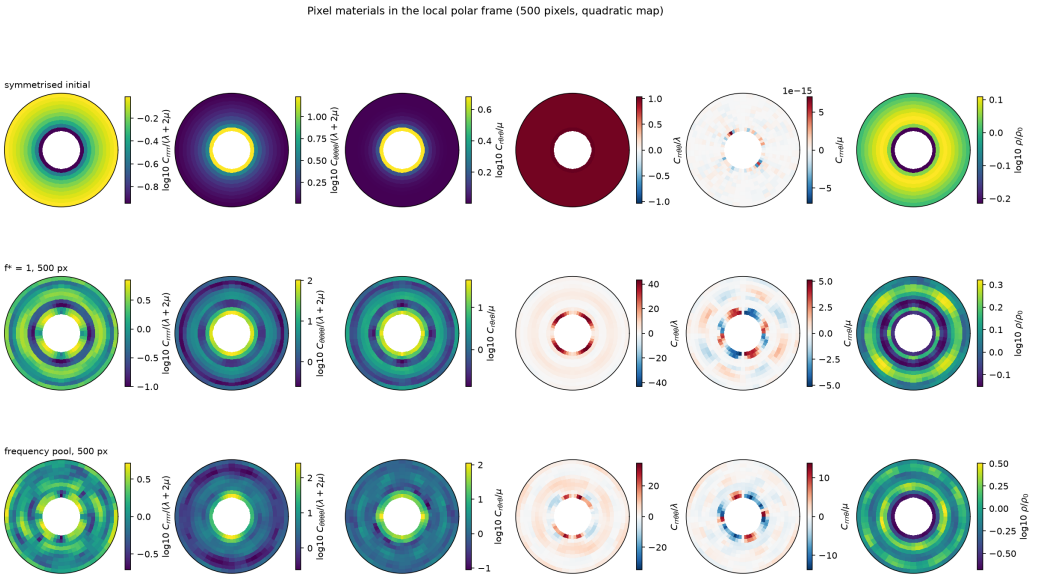


Figure 16: Pixel materials of the symmetrised initial design and of two optimised designs, in the local polar frame. Logarithmic scale for the normal and shear stiffness and the density.

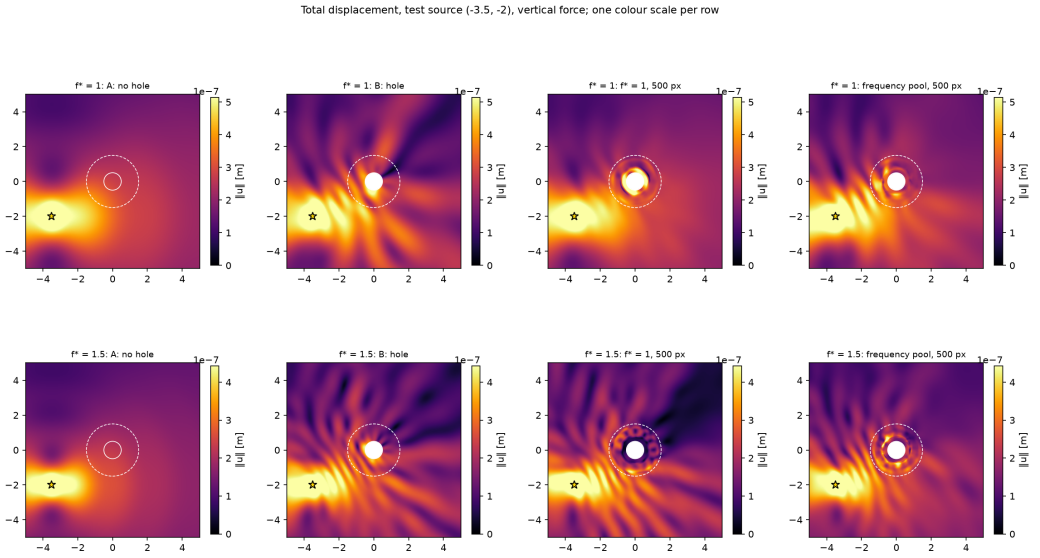


Figure 17: Total displacement for the test source $(-3.5, -2)$ m and vertical force at $f^* = 1$ (top) and 1.5 (bottom).

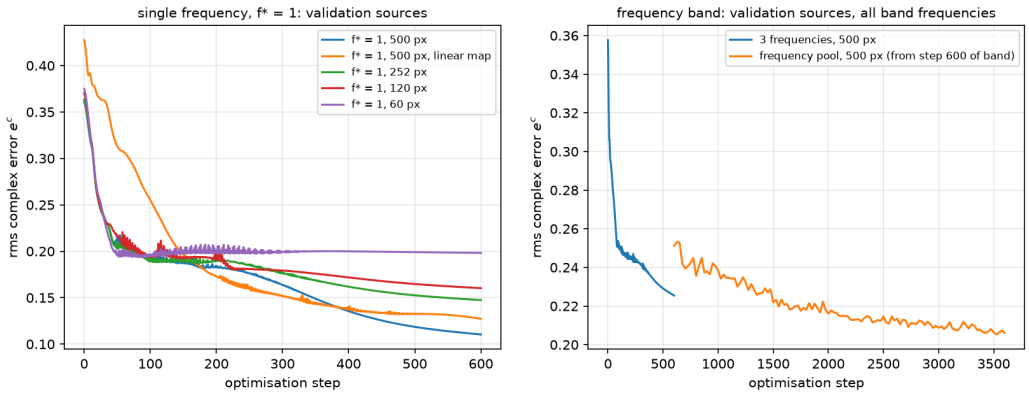


Figure 18: Validation error during optimisation. Right: the two band runs use different validation frequencies (three and eleven), so their levels are not directly comparable.

8. Discussion

Theorem 1 turns the assessment of a regularised cloak into the comparison of two ordinary problems. Without case D, a small value of C vs. A alone would not tell whether the residual comes from ε or from the discretisation. Here the decomposition shows that it comes from ε at the base resolution, and that the numerical error is smaller. The comparison of layers also shows why a validation against an analytic reference is needed in addition: the original damping layer had a 3.5% complex error against (17), invisible in C vs. A.

For the continuous cloak, our results have the following limits. Only two source positions were considered, with frequency up to $b/\lambda_S = 2.5$ and one geometry, $b = 3a$. Refinement near the cavity and quadrature order were not studied separately, and the behaviour of C vs. D on finer meshes remains open. Case B has no independent reference such as a series solution for the cavity. The PML was tested through its effect on case A, and the elastodynamic stability of the layer was not analysed beyond the frequency-domain results. The medium (8) has strong contrast at small ε and broken minor symmetry, up to about 0.45 in the relative measure of Fig. 2, and we have not addressed how it would be realised.

For the pixelated cloaks, the main lesson is that the cost of a realisable cloak comes from symmetry, not from pixels: with the ideal tensor, 500 pixels reach e between about 4×10^{-3} and 3×10^{-2}, while symmetrisation leaves the cavity no better hidden than without a cloak. Gradient-based

optimisation of admissible materials recovers a large part of this loss, but generalises only when it is trained on many source positions, and across frequency only when it is trained on a band. Even then a gap of more than two orders of magnitude (0.042 against about 10^{-4}) remains to the continuous Cosserat cloak, which a Cauchy material cannot reproduce exactly. Natural next steps are longer training on more sources and frequencies, constraints on contrast and on rotational symmetry, and the realisation of the pixel materials by microstructures.

9. Conclusion

We have formulated and validated a regularised continuous cloak for a circular cavity embedded in an elastic medium and excited by bulk waves. An exact equivalence with a hole of radius ε yields a direct way of separating regularisation and numerical errors, and implies traction continuity at the outer interface for any increasing C^1 radial map. With a stretched-coordinate PML and quadratic elements, the model agrees with a closed-form reference and satisfies superposition and mirror identities. For $b = \lambda_S$ and $\varepsilon/a = 0.01$, the cloak reduces the normalised exterior error in total displacement from 0.158 to 6.7×10^{-5}. The error scales as ε^2, and remains below 3.2×10^{-4} for all force directions, source positions and frequencies tested. Replacing the ideal medium by 500 pixels of admissible Cauchy material and optimising them reduces the median error on unseen sources from 0.158 to 0.042 at one frequency, or by a factor of 1.4 to 2.3 over a band of frequencies, while symmetrisation alone does not cloak.

Data availability

The code, configurations and result tables are in the `circular_cloak` branch of the project repository. The drivers are the following files in its `scripts` directory:

- `circular_step1.py`
- `circular_frequency_sweep.py`
- `circular_ratio_diagnostic.py`
- `circular_pixel_baseline.py`

- `circular_optimize.py`
- `circular_hole_reference.py`
- `circular_step2_figures.py`

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